UNIT 3 RESPONDING TO JOB ADVERTISEMENTS

Structure

3.0 Objectives

3.1 Warm Up

3.2 Reading Comprehension: Responding to Job Ads

3.3 Vocabulary: Related to Advertisements

3.4 Listening: To a Conversation

3.5 Speaking: Role Play, Telephoning

3.6 Grammar: Non-finites (Names of Skills, Intentions, kind of job)

3.7 Writing: Responding to an Advertisement

3.8 Let Us Sum Up

3.9 Answers

3.0 OBJECTIVES

This unit will help you to:

- Learn and practise structures around advertising and responding to advertisements
- Understand the language of an advertisement
- Develop vocabulary related to jobs
- Use polite language to make enquiries
- Be aware of language structures and vocabulary required to respond to advertisements

3.1 WARM UP

Read the two advertisements given and discuss the following:

1) Who put in the advertisement?
2) What is the person/organization looking for?
3) What are the skills required for the job?
4) If you were interested in the job mentioned what would you want to know?
5) What is the basic difference between the two advertisements?

Advertisement 1

Positions of two full time Senior Consultants in Physics

Location: IGNOU, Maidan Garhi, New Delhi
Date Listed: 01-Aug-2...

The School of Sciences invites application from candidates for the positions of two full-time Senior Consultants in Physics. They will be involved in helping the faculty in developing theory and practical components of Physics electives

of B. Sc. (CBCS) programme, IGNOU Vacancy Details: No of posts: 02 Name of the post: Sr Consultant

Age Limit: The maximum age limit for these posts is 68 years on the date of advertisement.

Essential Qualifications: PhD. in Physics with minimum 10 years teaching experience at UG/PG level.

Desirable: 1. Teaching of Electronics, Optics, Electromagnetic Theory, Nuclear Physics, Quantum Mechanics, Thermodynamics and Statistical Mechanics at UG/PG level along with other Physics Courses. 2. Experience of writing text books and SLMs at UG/PG level.

Selection Process: Candidates will be selected through an Interview.

How to Apply: Eligible candidates can attend the interview along with application in the prescribed format with original documents and zerox copies of the same on 31.08.2018

Last date of receipt of application: 31.08.2...

Advertisement 2

Hotel Jobs in London **Ad ID:** 5849316

Location: London
Date Listed: 12-Aug-2...

A BRITISH MULTINATIONAL COMPANY IN HOTEL INDUSTRY BUSINESS IS LOOKING FOR WORKERS TO WORK IN BRITAIN. FLIGHT TICKETS AND ACCOMODATION IN LONDON WILL BE PROVIDED. VACANCY FOR CLEANERS, GARDENERS, STEWARDS, DRIVERS, BAR ATTENDANTS, PLUMBERS, P.R.MANAGERS, LANGUAGE TRANSLATORS, WATCHMAN, RECEIPTIONIST, CLERKS, COOKS, ACCOUNTANTS, TECHNICIANS, WEB DESIGNERS, PROGRAMMERS, etc.

Interested? Contact: P.N.Suresh. (for Langdith Hotels Ltd)
suresh@yahoo.com

(Adapted from the Internet)

3.2 READING COMPREHENSION: RESPONDING TO JOB ADS

Read the guidelines given for responding to an advertisement and then extract the relevant information from the advertisement that follows.

Thousands of employers use classified ads as a means to advertise vacancies and even more people respond to these ads, but only a few applicants ever get a positive response. You may think, so why bother with these ads? If you consider the competition for one job, it may seem a futile operation, but there are a few secrets for responding to job ads and if you make use of these tips, your chances of landing the job increase tremendously.

Benefits of responding to job ads

The job ads are the ideal place to find a comprehensive directory of businesses that are looking for employees. There is normally a bit of information about the company and the best of all - you get an idea of what the companies are looking for, what they expect, and in some cases, what they are willing to pay.

How to use the classified ads

It is better not to look for entry level jobs since these types of ads will be in the minority, rather scan the ads to find who is hiring and where possible, to find the names of the recruitment officers

Step 1: Select the advertising vehicle

Subscribe or purchase newspapers that run job ads for the area where you would like to locate a job as well as any national papers or magazines that focus on your particular job industry. Make a list of Internet sites that run classified job ads and browse them regularly as well.

Step 2: The scanning process

If you are a beginner, mark the entry level jobs and respond to them first. You should be prepared to be at the company first thing in the morning. You secondly, must also mark entry level openings in other job fields. They may not directly apply to you, but it indicates that the enterprise is willing to employ at the entry level.

Thirdly, scan the ads that indicate that experience and higher qualifications are needed. Even though you won't get the advertised job, you get valuable information such as who the manager is, the name of the recruitment officer, and the types of job responsibilities that you can expect.

Step 3 Make a list

Before you start responding to job ads, you need to make a list of all the relevant hiring companies and the positions advertised.

Best time for responding to job ads

If you saw a job ad in a weekend paper, you should respond on Monday. Don't mail your CV since it will only arrive later in the week. Emails only get read around Tuesday or Wednesday, so you need to be at their offices on Monday before the rest of the applicants respond. If the ad doesn't say "No calls" then you can make a phone call to enquire, but if it states that calls are not welcome, you should pay them a personal visit. Most employers urgently look for replacements and will be too happy not to deal with thousands of applicants and that is why you should help them out by responding on Monday. You need not call for an interview or meeting, just arrive at their offices with your CV and well prepared for an interview.

Now look at the advertisement given below:

MY LADY JEWELLERS
PVT LTD.

A fast growing fashion jewellery manufacturing company based in Singapore is looking for the expansion of its Marketing Division.

REQUIRED ARE: SALES OFFICERS, AREA SALES MANAGER, ACCOUNTANT, OFFICE ASSISTANT CUM COMPUTER OPERATOR

Candidates must be graduates with 3-5 years of experience

SALARY NO BAR

For prior appointment contact:

9888833300 Fax: 22459876

Activity 1

Answer these questions:

1) i) What kind of information does one get from these classified advertisements?

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ii) Where would you find classified advertisements? List them.

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iii) Why do we call a newspaper an advertising vehicle?

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iv) Which kind of jobs must you apply for? Why?

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v) Why must you mark the entry level jobs of the company even if they do not apply to you?

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vi) Why must one scan jobs that require 'experience' and 'higher qualifications'?

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ignou THE PEOPLE'S UNIVERSITY

vii) What is the best thing to do if the advertisement says 'No calls"? Why?

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2) Answer the following questions related to the advertisement.

i) In your opinion, what size company is 'My Lady Jewellers'?

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ii) Does the reader know where he/she will be posted? Why?

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iii) Match the post with the required skill/qualification. The skills are provided in the box below. One skill may be applicable to more than one post.

a) Sales Officer: .....

.....

b) Accountant: .....

.....

c) Office Assistant-cum-computer operator: .....

.....

a) Taking notes in short-hand	b) A degree in sales management
c) A degree in Accountancy	d) Operating a computer efficiently
e) Communicating effectively	f) Telephoning
g) Keeping books and ledgers	h) Convincing people
i) Making spreadsheets	j) Preparing and typing letters
k) Interviewing people	l) Preparing tour reports
m) Guiding and training new recruits	

iv) Is the salary negotiable? Pick the sentence that illustrates this.

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v) Is there any entry level post? How can you tell?

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vi) In view of what we read in the passage 'Responding to Job Ads' would it be all right to walk into their office with your resume unannounced? What should one do first?

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vii) Why is the address of the company office not provided? Guess the possible reason(s).

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3.3 VOCABULARY: RELATED TO ADVERTISEMENTS

Activity 2

In the grid below are places where one may come across advertisements. Find them.

L	M	R	U	I	O	N	J	X	Y	C	T	U	H	W
K	S	G	F	I	L	E	A	A	W	A	T	R	M	D
H	T	B	S	N	E	W	Y	F	G	B	O	A	R	D
A	B	U	D	J	O	S	O	D	E	L	Q	A	W	G
N	J	L	R	O	O	P	O	S	T	E	R	D	Q	T
D	P	L	Q	P	I	A	K	I	L	L	A	S	T	E
B	I	E	W	X	N	P	O	D	D	S	D	Z	T	D
I	N	T	E	R	N	E	T	A	K	E	I	X	D	E
L	S	I	B	A	E	R	C	R	Y	S	O	W	R	T
L	W	N	O	Z	T	W	E	L	D	A	M	E	L	L
S	F	G	X	Z	L	A	L	D	M	V	N	E	G	K
D	Y	U	S	E	L	S	O	O	I	T	T	R	J	K

Clues:

i) Advertisements printed on small pieces of paper and distributed with the newspaper or stuck on walls or key places for people to see.

ii) Places where people put notices and general information.

iii) What one surfs on the computer when one wants information? We need a telephone or cable connection for this.

iv) Another word for the network we can access using the computer and the cable.

v) That which provides us connectivity to different sources of relay and telecast and which allows us to watch things telecast in far off places on our television sets.

vi) That which brings in the news and a fund of information every morning.

vii) Large printed matter on thick paper which we find stuck on public places.

viii) The device that brings across songs, plays, news and jingles without pictures.

3.4 LISTENING: TO A CONVERSATION

Activity 3

Listen to the conversation and tick the correct alternative.

i) Super Designers advertised/did not advertise the job in newspaper.

ii) There was/were only one/a few jobs advertised.

iii) The post of the Illustrator was at number 3 /4.

iv) The receptionist connected Martin Day to the design/arts department.

v) Martin Day has a degree in fine arts/commercial art.

vi) He has the required/less than the required experience.

vii) Martin Day needs/does not need an appointment for a walk-in-interview.

viii) The time given to him is 11.30 on Thursday/Wednesday.

ix) Lilian Thomas was encouraging/not so encouraging in her replies to Martin Day.

x) He has been advised to bring in some landscapes/portraits that he has drawn.

3.5 SPEAKING: ROLE PLAY, TELEPHONING

Activity 4

You have just listened to a conversation between a candidate for a job and the office staff of the company.

Now play the roles of the following persons in pairs.

Role 1

Geoffrey Baldwin: is aspiring to become a Sales Officer in a publishing house, called Indigo Publishers. Has a post graduate degree in commerce. Has experience of working as a Sales Executive in a firm that deals in computer parts (three years and five months, one year and seven months less than the 5-7 years mentioned in the advertisement). Wishes to change his line a bit. Willing to learn how to market books.

Mary Thomas is the front office assistant. She receives the call and after the initial talk transfers it to Usmaan Khan, the Sales Manager.
Usmaan Khan enquires about his qualifications. He also asks him about his experience. Asks him why he wants to shift. Asks him whether he would be able to learn how to market books.

3.6 GRAMMAR: NON-FINITES (NAMES OF SKILLS, INTENTIONS, KIND OF JOB)

Activity 5

I) When we talk of the skills required for a job or the abilities one has we often tend to use words like: typing, contacting, marketing, handling, issuing, working on a computer, designing etc.

Look at these sentences:

a) I have some knowledge of **accounting** but **preparing** excel sheets would be difficult for me initially.

b) **Handling** the Excel Programme is not very difficult. You will learn it in no time.

c) Try **telephoning** the manager after 5.30 in the evening. He is usually back from his field work by then.

d) Are you good at **convincing** people?

You will notice that the highlighted words are formed by adding 'ing' to a verb and are used as nouns. They can be the subject or the object of a verb. These verb-nouns are called **Gerunds.**

1) Complete the sentences given below using gerunds.

   i) Your job will include……**(write)**, I mean …… (**type)** letters, ……. (**answer)** the telephone, ……. (**take)** dictation and …..…… (**maintain)** the files.

   ii) Sir, there's Mr. Randhawa on the telephone. He has been …….. (**call**) since morning.

   iii) Think carefully before……(**join)** your new assignment. Remember in order to do so you will be..……(**quit**) a comfortable job.

   iv) The skill of ……..(**read**) and ……..(**write**) in English is essential for an office boy's job here.

   v) Simply …….(**place**) an advertisement in a popular daily will fetch us many candidates.

   vi) …….(**respond**) to job advertisements is a skill that freshers must learn.

vii) The Manager is always busy nowadays. ……(**interview**) candidates for different jobs takes up most of his time.

viii)……..(**market**) designer clothes can be tricky. One never knows when someone will simply copy them instead of ……(**buy**) them.

II) So far you have learnt one function of the verb+ ing form (as a noun). Now look at these sentences and say whether they are functioning as nouns or something else.

i) The two Companies had **conflicting** interests.

ii) The General Manager of the Company saw his staff **coming** in late.

iii) The lady **sitting** near the counter is the next candidate for the interview.

iv) The lady I spoke to had a very **encouraging** tone when I asked about my chances of getting the job.

You will notice that these words are functioning as describing words or adjectives and telling us more about the nouns they are qualifying. Hence **encouraging** voice, **conflicting** interests, **coming** in late, **sitting** near the counter. These are present participles.

Similarly we have past participles formed by adding 'ed' to a verb (published, cleaned) or the third form of irregular verbs (fallen, driven).

2) Complete the sentences using the appropriate participles.

i) The ……(type) letters are ready for dispatch.

ii) Please remove the ……..(break) chairs from the hall. We shall have our meeting here.

iii) Joan and Raul reached the ……..(meet) point well before the appointed time. They wanted to be punctual on the day of the informal interview.

iv) I think a line is ……..(miss) in the letter. Please insert it and have it …… (dispatch).

v) Please show me a few samples of a ……(cover) letter.

vi) This is a …….. (well-pay) job. Everyone wants it.

vii) The …… (attend) patients looked settled while the …….. (un, attend) ones looked…… (dis, satisfy).

viii) The company has changed its name. All the letter heads have been printed afresh. Please use the …….(change) letterheads.

3.7 WRITING: RESPONDING TO AN ADVERTISEMENT

After you have decided that you would like to apply for a particular post you need to send them your CV or resume which you will read about in a later unit.

You would need to prepare a covering letter with your application.

You will now read a covering letter in response to a job advertisement. The important thing in this letter is that you need to show that your skills match the job you are applying for.

Activity 6

Imagine that you have received training in film scripting from the Institute of Mass Communication, Ireland after getting a degree in Film Production. You have worked as an assistant with a Scriptwriter at Ronald and Smith Studios for over five years.

You are applying for the job of Junior Script Writer at Worldwide Films, Riverwalk, Tampa, Florida.

Say you are looking for an opportunity to work with a big film company. Also mention that since you have a special degree and five years of experience you would be happy to assist with the script of a full-fledged film.

Say that you can be reached at the above address and telephone number. Tell them when you would call to find out about the status of your application.

Your language needs to be polite but not ingratiating.

3.8 LET US SUM UP

It is important for us to keep looking at various vehicles of advertisements and read them carefully for the information given in them. In case we have queries we can call them up and clarify our doubts unless they have clearly indicated that they would not entertain any calls. When we visit them we should take all our necessary papers so that we are prepared for an impromptu interview. It is important to give a complete picture of your skills and qualifications and be honest with them while answering their queries. A polite but confident covering letter goes a long way in ensuring that your application will be read and you will be considered for the job.

3.9 ANSWERS

Warm Up

Advertisement 1

1) IGNOU, New Delhi
2) Inviting applications for the post of Senior Consultants.
3) Experience of writing text books and SLMs at UG/PG level
4) Whether the recruiters will consider freshers/candidates without any work experience.
5) The first advertisement is of an academic institution while the second is from hospitality sector.

Advertisement 2

1) A British Multinational in the Hotel Business.

2) Candidates looking for jobs ranging from cleaners, gardeners, stewards, drivers, computer programmers to managers related to the hospitality industry to work in Britain.

3) Each job requires the relevant qualification or skill:

   Cleaners: skill of using various gadgets for cleaning

   Gardeners: skill of planting, growing and maintaining gardens and lawns.

   Stewards: Diploma in Hotel Management, etc.

4) Since it is already mentioned that flight tickets and stay will be looked after by the employers the candidates would want to know the salary, working hours, holidays, the perks and the retirement benefits.

5) This advertisement is different from the first one as it has been placed by an organization looking for fresh recruits.

Reading Comprehension

Activity 1

1) i) One gets to know a bit about the company and what it is willing to pay for a job and the qualifications they are looking for in the candidate for a specific job. You also get to know the names of the recruiting officers.

   ii) One can find these advertisements in newspapers, magazines and Internet sites.

   iii) A newspaper is an advertising vehicle because it carries a lot of different kinds of advertisements and is still the most popular place to look for advertisements.

   iv) Since one is a fresher one must apply for the entry level jobs. One can apply for the higher level jobs once one has obtained experience.

   v) We need to mark these jobs to identify the companies and organizations that employ at entry level. They may have jobs suiting one at a later stage. So one can keep them handy.

   vi) These jobs give a good picture of who the manager will be or the name of the recruiting officer and the job responsibilities one can expect.

   vii) The best thing to do is to pay them a visit personally. This means they do not welcome calls and telephonic enquiries. Of course, one needs to carry one's resume and the relevant papers in case they decide to interview immediately.

2) Answers related to adverdisement.

   i) 'My Lady Jewellers' is a middle-sized company

ii) The place of posting or the location of its new Marketing Division is not mentioned. Either it is not yet finalized or they want to take people who would be willing to move and would come with an open mind.

iii) a) Sales Officer: **A degree in Sales Management, communicating effectively, preparing tour reports, guiding and training new recruits, convincing people.**

b) Accountant: **A degree in Accountancy, keeping books and ledgers**, **making spreadsheets, operating a computer efficiently.**

c) Office Assistant-cum-Computer Operator: **Communicating effectively, convincing people, taking notes in short-hand, telephoning, preparing and typing letters**.

iv) Yes. The line 'Salary No Bar' shows this.

v) There is no entry level post since they are asking for experience of 3-5 years.

vi) No, it would be right to first telephonically contact them and fix an appointment.

vii) Possibly the area of posting is not decided or they do not want to reveal it. They might also wish to know who would be willing to move out of their city.

Vocabulary

Activity 2

i) Advertisements printed on small pieces of paper and distributed with the newspaper or stuck on walls or key places for people to see- **Handbills**

ii) Place where people put notices and general information- **Board (Notice)**

iii) What one surfs on the computer when one wants information… We need a telephone or cable connection for this- **Internet**

iv) Another word for the network we can access using the computer and the cable- **Web**

v) That which provides us connectivity to different sources of relay and telecast and which allows us to watch things telecast in far off places on our television sets- **Cable**

vi) That which brings in the news and a fund of information every morning- **Newspaper**

vii) Large printed matter on thick paper which we find stuck on public places- **Poster**

viii) The device that brings across songs, plays, news and jingles without pictures- **Radio**

Listening

Activity 3

TAPESCRIPT

A) (Female voice): Hello, Superb Designers. How may I help you?

B) (Male voice): Hello, my name is Martin Day. I called up regarding a job you have advertised in the Sunday edition of the Times of Dubai.

A: Which particular job are you talking about?

B: The job of an Illustrator. It is at number 4 in your advertisement.

A: Right. Let me just connect you with our arts department. Ms. Lilian Thomas will assist you.
(Pause)

C) (Different female voice): Hello, this is the arts department. I am Lilian Thomas. What is your query, sir?

B: I have a graduation certificate from the School of Arts, Addis Ababa. I have graduated in commercial art.

C: Yes. That's good.

B: But I don't have five years experience. My experience is just over four years. Do you think I should apply?

C: A little over four years, you said. Umm.. Well, there is no harm in trying your luck.

B: You have mentioned a walk-in-interview. Can you give me an appointment for the same?

C: Let me check. Wednesday at 11.30 would be fine. I hope it suits you.

B: Yes. I shall be there. One last question. What would you advise me to carry with me apart from my resume and certificates?

C: It would be a good idea to bring some of your sketches. Have you done any human figures or portraits?

B: Yes, a few.

C: Bring them along. All the best. (Click)

Activity 3

i) Super Designers **advertised** the job in newspaper.

ii) There were only **a few** jobs advertised.

iii) The post of the Illustrator was at number **4**.

iv) The receptionist connected Martin Day to the **arts department**.

v) Martin Day has a degree in **commercial art**.

vi) He has **less than the required** experience.

Vii) Martin Day **needs** an appointment for a walk-in-interview.

viii) The time given to him is 11.30 on **Wednesday**.

ix) Lilian Thomas was **encouraging** in her replies to Martin Day.

x) He has been advised to bring in some **portraits** that he has drawn.

Speaking

Activity 4

The dialogue might be like this.

Mary Thomas:	Indigo Publishers. Can I help you?
Geoffrey Baldwin:	I wanted to enquire about the post of Sales officer in your publishing house.
Mary:	Hold on, I'll connect you to Mr. Usman Khan, our Sales Manager.
Geoffrey:	Thank you.
Mary:	Go ahead. You are through.
Usmaan Khan:	Hello.
Geoffrey:	Hello, my name is Geoffrey Baldwin. I wanted to apply for the post of Sales Officer in your Publishing House.
Usmaan:	May I know your qualifications Mr. Baldwin, if you don't mind?
Geoffrey:	Yes, of course. I have a Post Graduate degree in Commerce.
Usmaan:	Good, and do you have any experience of sales?
Geoffrey:	Yes, I do. I am working as a Sales Executive in a firm that deals in computer parts.
Usmaan:	For how many years have you been working?
Geoffrey:	For three years and five months. Do you think I should apply since my experience is one year and seven months short?
Usmaan:	There is no harm in applying. But why do you wish to shift to selling books, Mr. Baldwin?
Geoffrey:	I want a change.
Usmaan:	You will have to learn marketing of books very quickly. Would you be able to do that?
Geoffrey:	Oh yes, I am willing to learn the trade as fast as I can.
Usmaan:	Good. In that case come to the office with your resume and your certificates at 11.30 a.m. on Thursday. I hope that suits you.
Geoffrey:	Oh that's fine. I'll be there. Thank you for your time, sir. (Click)

Grammar

Activity 5

1) i) Your job will include **writing**, I mean **typing** letters, **answering** the telephone, **taking** dictation and **maintaining** the files.

ii) Sir, there's Mr. Randhawa on the telephone. He has been **calling** since morning.

iii) Think carefully before **joining** your new assignment. Remember in order to do so you will be **quittin**g a comfortable job.

iv) The skill of **reading** and **writing** in English is essential for an office boy's job here.

v) Simply **placing** an advertisement in a popular daily will fetch us many candidates.

vi) **Responding** to job advertisements is a skill that freshers must learn.

vii) The Manager is always busy nowadays. **Interviewing** candidates for different jobs take up most of his time.

viii) **Marketing** designer clothes can be tricky. One never knows when someone will simply copy them instead of **buying** them.

2) i) The **typed** letters are ready for dispatch.

ii) Please remove the **broken** chairs from the hall. We shall have our meeting here.

iii) Joan and Raul reached the **meeting** point well before the appointed time. They wanted to be punctual on the day of the informal interview.

iv) I think a line is **missing** in the letter. Please insert it and have them **dispatched**.

v) Please show me a few samples of a **covering** letter.

vi) This is a **well -paid** job. Everyone wants it.

vii) The **attended** patients looked settled while the **unattended** ones looked **dissatisfied**.

viii) The company has changed its name. All the letter heads have been printed afresh. Please use the **changed** letterheads.

Activity 6

(You may write your name and address here and your telephone number)

Date

…….(Any name)

Worldwide Films

44, Riverwalk

Tampa

Florida, FL 0000888

Sub: Application for the post of Junior Script Writer

Dear Mr./Ms ……,

I have been working as an assistant with Scriptwriter at Ronald and Smith Studios for the last five years. I have received training in film scripting from the Institute of Mass Communication, Ireland after getting a degree in Mass Communication from an institute in Durban. I believe that my qualifications and experience will help me to be a good Junior Script writer, the post I aspire for, in your, company.

Although I am happy working at the Ronald and Smith Studios assisting in writing scripts for the television, I wish to have some experience in films. So I am looking for an opportunity to work with a big film company. Since I have a special degree in film scripting and five years of experience with television I am very interested in assisting with the script of a full-fledged film. Here, I wish to add that my communication skills are excellent and I am very comfortable working in a team.

I have attached the testimonials along with my application. Should you find my application suitable for the post of Junior Scriptwriter you may contact me at the address or the telephone number given above. I shall be calling your office within ten days to find out the status of my application. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

(Signature)

(Name)

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